

```

$_SESSION['time'] = time();
echo '<br /><a href="ourpage.php">page 2</a>';
echo '<br /><a href=" ourpage.php?" . SID .
">page 2</a>';
?>

```

The page `ourpage.php` contains the session data when this page will be navigated through the above example.

9.6. Session variables

Sessions in PHP are like the server side cookie files. It stores variables. PHP scripts can be read as well as these stored variables can be written. Session files are created as per user requests. These files can only be accessed on the request of the same user. For example, take an HTML form with a user name and occupation. This HTML form transmits the data to other pages with a session file.

The new data page comprises of one HTML form requesting a user to enter his/her name and occupation. The details are then passed as name-value pairs, called `$name` and `$job` to a PHP page. The PHP pages store all the information as session variables. The first part of the code on the HTML page and all other pages is required for accessing the following variables: `<?php session_start(); ?>`

The code mentioned above, basically has two functions and performs as per your request. If you do not have a session, it creates a new session. It connects to the existing session file, if you have a session. After a new session is created, a session identifier is generated by the PHP session management. This session identifier is a string comprising of 32 hex digits. It creates an empty session file on the server as `'sess_'` followed by the session identifier. In turn, it creates a set-cookie and a session cookie in the browser according to the session identifier value.

Any request by the user to the server includes the session identifier with PHP connecting to the exact session file. Going back to the HTML form page, an HTML form is created on the user's browser. The user fills in the required details and clicks on the send button. The filled form with variables is sent to the PHP page storing the variables. Now the code appears as follows: